

Paper 1: Speaking in French

Content

Speaking tasks will feature content that is relatable and accessible to all students. Students will be assessed on their ability to:

- speak using clear and comprehensible language, for a range of audiences and purposes, and in formal and informal contexts, which are relevant to their current and future needs and interests.

Students will need to:

- use clear and comprehensible pronunciation when speaking French, demonstrating an understanding of sound symbol correspondences
- recall and use language in different situations and be able to move between French and English
- convey and elicit information by asking and answering questions
- use language to describe a visual stimulus, including specific required details
- give opinions
- develop conversation and discussion
- produce extended sequences of speech
- use a range of vocabulary and grammatical structures (from the prescribed lists) accurately, including some more complex forms appropriate to the level of study, with reference to past, present and future events.

Assessment information

Task 1 – Read aloud (12 marks)

Students will:

- **read aloud a short passage** (8 marks) and
- **answer two straightforward questions** (4 marks) to elicit brief opinions based on the overall content of the passage, in a short interaction.

The **read aloud task assesses clear and comprehensible pronunciation** integrated with **an understanding of sound symbol correspondences**.

The short interaction that follows assesses communication only.

Each assessment series, Pearson will provide six read aloud stimulus cards. Each card will take its focus from one of the six thematic contexts listed in the specification and will only use words selected from the full vocabulary list for each tier.

When responding to the two questions after the read aloud, students can draw upon any relevant vocabulary from the full vocabulary list, or beyond the list. The questions will be in the present tense at both tiers and will elicit likes / dislikes / opinions.

Assessment information:

For each read aloud, there is a student card and a teacher card:

Student card

The student card includes:

- instructions and a scenario in English,
- followed by a short text in French, which the student will read aloud:
 - **Foundation tier: 35–40 words in 5 sentences**
 - **Higher tier: 50–55 words in 4 sentences**

The two straightforward questions for the short interaction do not appear on the student card, as they must be unprepared.

Teacher card

The teacher card includes:

- instructions on how to conduct the task,
- a copy of the text to be read by the student, and
- two straightforward questions, which form the short unprepared interaction to follow the read aloud of the text.

Task 2 – Role play (10 marks)

In the role play, students will be required to **give and receive information, answering and asking questions**. The students' interactions could include any of the following:

- make transactions (buying tickets, ordering food etc)
- make plans, appointments or reservations
- explain or give reasons
- describe
- express likes / dislikes / preferences / opinions
- ask for advice
- make a complaint or report a problem
- ask / talk about activities.

Role plays will be transactional in nature and will always be in one of the following settings:

- Café / restaurant
- Shop / market / shopping centre
- Hotel
- Train station
- Tourist information office
- Cinema / theatre / concert hall

- Campsite
- Leisure centre
- Doctor's surgery / hospital
- In town

The role play assesses communication only and has been designed so that students can respond to the prompts using vocabulary drawn from the vocabulary list.

Each assessment series, Pearson will provide six role play stimulus cards, which will use six different settings from the above list.

The role plays are all set in a formal context. Students are not required to use the formal register.

Assessment information:

- For each role play, there is a student card and teacher card:

Student card

The student card includes the role play setting taken from the list above, and instructions and prompts in English.

Foundation tier:

- The student card includes five bullet points, eliciting five utterances.
- Students need to **ask one question**.
- Students are required to speak only in the present tense or a familiar conditional tense where it is more natural to do so, e.g. 'je voudrais.'

Higher tier:

- The student cards include five bullet points, eliciting five utterances.
- Students need to **ask two questions**.
- Students are required to speak in the present tense or a familiar conditional tense where it is more natural to do so, e.g. 'je voudrais.'
- Students **respond to one question asked using a future timeframe**.

Teacher card

The teacher cards contain instructions on how to conduct the role play and the exact questions to ask.

Each role play opens with an introduction from the teacher who then asks the first question.

Task 3 – Picture task (28 marks)

Students will be required to:

- **describe one picture** from a choice of two (8 marks)
- answer **two** unprepared questions related to the selected picture (4 marks)
- participate in **a conversation extending from the broader thematic context** (16 marks).

Picture description (12 marks):

On the picture task card there will be two colour pictures and students will **choose one** of the colour pictures. They will be required to **produce an extended description**, focussing on the following compulsory details of the picture:

- people
- location
- activity.

The teacher is provided with prompts to encourage students to address the compulsory bullet points. Students are not limited to describing these details and may develop their description as far as they are able in the recommended time.

The picture description has been designed so that students can respond to the stimulus using vocabulary drawn from the full vocabulary list.

Once the student has concluded the description, the teacher will ask **two compulsory questions relating to the subject matter of the picture**. Both questions will be about the student's own experiences / likes / dislikes / opinions. At Higher tier, the second question will be in a past tense. The questions do not appear on the student card as they must be unprepared.

Broader conversation (16 marks):

The teacher should continue **a broader conversation extending from the thematic context** selected for this task. A compulsory starting subject for the conversation is given on the teacher card, along with example questions in the present, past and future tenses.

During the conversation, the teacher should ask a range of questions appropriate to the thematic context and the interests and experiences of the student, which enables students to:

- produce extended sequences of speech
- develop the conversation
- give and justify own thoughts and opinions
- refer to past, present and future events
- demonstrate the full range of their ability.

Teacher-examiners should endeavour to sustain a free-flowing conversation, in which they respond to what the candidate is saying. In the broader conversation, students can draw upon any relevant vocabulary from the full vocabulary list, or beyond the list.

Teacher-examiners should be mindful of the time recommendation for the conversation element of this task and encourage candidates to produce sufficient responses to fill the recommended time.

Assessment information

The description and conversation elements of the picture task assess communication and clarity (in response to the picture stimulus or teacher questions), and linguistic and grammatical accuracy.

The two unprepared questions following the picture description assess communication only.

Each assessment series, Pearson will provide eighteen different sets of picture task stimulus cards for each tier, with each card relating to one of the six thematic contexts. There will be two pictures on each stimulus card.

Two weeks in advance of the speaking assessment, students will select the thematic context for the picture task and conversation. They will select one thematic context from a choice of two, randomly generated by Pearson. This will inform the stimulus card they receive for the picture task, and the read aloud and role play task cards will be randomly allocated accordingly by Pearson.

For each picture task set, there is a student card and teacher card:

Student card

The student card includes:

- **two colour pictures** from which students must **choose one** to describe.
- **three compulsory bullet points in English** to guide the description: the people, the location, the activity.
- guidance on the task.

Teacher card

The teacher card includes:

- instructions on how to conduct this task.
- copies of the pictures with bullet point prompts as on the student card.
- intervention prompts to encourage the student to develop their picture description.
- two compulsory follow-on questions per picture, related to the subject matter of the picture
 - **Foundation tier:** the questions will both be in the present tense;
 - **Higher tier:** question 1 will be in present tense and question 2 will be in the past tense.
- guidance for the broader conversation, including a mandated starting subject for the conversation, and three suggested questions in different tenses / timeframes.

General assessment information

First assessment: May/June 2026.

- Students complete the three tasks as detailed and in the order set out above.
- Assessment rubrics and information for students will be in English. The tasks must be completed in French.
- Prior to the assessment, Pearson will provide instructions on the process for allocating stimulus cards. The allocation of cards for the read aloud, role play and picture task will be generated by the student's choice of thematic context for the picture task. The thematic context will be selected from a choice of two randomly generated by Pearson and offered to the student two weeks before the assessment. The allocation of cards is designed to ensure that the assessment experienced by each student samples a range of vocabulary from the specified vocabulary list *in Appendix 1: Vocabulary*.
- Assessments are conducted by centres within a five-week assessment period in April and May in any single year. Dates for the assessment period will be confirmed in the UK Information Manual at the start of each academic year. The assessment period will not always be continuous or be the same period each year, for example it will need to accommodate the Easter break which changes each year.
- The assessment materials provided by Pearson for all tasks may be accessed by the teacher no more than three working days before the assessment period. This is to enable the teacher to prepare for the assessment. The assessment materials in the pack must not be removed from the centre premises and should be securely stored in order to maintain confidentiality throughout the assessment period.
- Assessments are conducted by teachers. Complete, unedited recordings of all assessments must be submitted to Pearson via the online Learner Work Transfer (LWT) portal for external marking.
- Assessment timings are different for Foundation and Higher tiers to reflect the increased demand of the tasks. Students will be assessed on the quality of the responses they can produce within the maximum allocated time of 9 minutes for foundation and 12 minutes for higher. Teachers are expected to give students the opportunity to respond fully to all tasks.
- All assessments are marked against assessment criteria, which can be found in the

- Centres must have procedures in place to verify and confirm the identity of all students at the time of the assessment. Pearson will provide the format for this verification, which will be submitted digitally to Pearson.

Foundation tier assessment time and marks

The total assessment for the three tasks is **7 to 9 minutes plus 15 minutes' preparation time.**

The assessment is worth 50 marks.

The assessment consists of three tasks which must be conducted in the following order:

- Task 1 – one read aloud with short interaction to follow, recommended to last between **1.5 to 2 minutes** for 12 marks
- Task 2 – one role play, recommended to last **1 to 1.5 minutes** for 10 marks
- Task 3 – one picture task, recommended to last **4.5 to 5.5 minutes** in total
 - the picture description with the two compulsory questions is recommended to last **1.5 to 2 minutes** for 12 marks, and
 - the broader conversation is recommended to last **3 to 3.5 minutes** for 16 marks.
 - The total number of marks for Task 3 is 28 marks.

Higher tier assessment time and marks

The total assessment for the three tasks is **10 to 12 minutes plus 15 minutes' preparation time.**

The assessment is worth 50 marks.

The assessment consists of three tasks which must be conducted in the following order:

- Task 1 – one read aloud with short interaction to follow, recommended to last between **2 and 2.5 minutes** for 12 marks
- Task 2 – one role play, recommended to last **1 to 1.5 minutes** for 10 marks
- Task 3 – one picture task, recommended to last **7 to 8 minutes** in total
 - the picture description with the two compulsory questions is recommended to last **2 to 2.5 minutes** for 12 marks,

- the broader conversation is recommended to last **5 to 5.5 minutes** for 16 marks.
- The total number of marks for Task 3 is 28 marks.

Preparation time

Students are allocated 15 minutes' preparation time, under supervised conditions, immediately prior to the assessment.

The purpose of the 15 minutes preparation time is to consider the text for the read aloud and the allocated stimuli for the role play and picture task.

The final 1 minute of the preparation time should take place in the examination room, where students will be given the opportunity to practise the read aloud task out loud. It is not compulsory for the student to read the full task out loud during this minute. Students may use this time to practise selected words / phrases / sentences or the entire text out loud or undertake any other appropriate preparation. The 1-minute preparation will not be assessed but **must** form part of the continuous recording of the assessment submitted to Pearson. The purpose of recording the preparation time is to ensure that no guidance or correction is provided to the student during this time.

During the 15 minute preparation time, students are permitted to make notes on an A4 sheet of paper. In addition, they can directly annotate the text for the read aloud in order to aid pronunciation during the task.

During the assessment, students can refer to notes and annotations. The notes should be for reference only. Stimulus material for each task should be handed to the teacher at the end of the task (i.e. directly after the read aloud passage, but before the short interaction; directly after the roleplay; at the end of the picture description). At the end of the examination, students must also return their notes to the teacher.

Any notes made during the preparation time must be kept securely by the centre until the end of October in the year the assessment is completed, after which time they should be securely destroyed.

Students cannot have access to a dictionary, or any other resource, during the preparation time.

Sample assessment materials

A sample paper and mark scheme for this can be found in the *Pearson Edexcel Level 1/Level 2 GCSE (9-1) in French Sample Assessment Materials (SAMs)* document.